

selling couples, both married and premarried, is that whatever I might convince them to do, somebody else coming along behind me could convince them otherwise. So I decided a long time ago that I would stop trying to convince them to do anything. Instead I would go back to the source of truth, God's Word, and let God do the convincing.

God requires some minimums of us as Christians. If you, as husband and wife, will establish the minimums that God's Word establishes, you will come out with a healthy, balanced marriage.

MINIMUM NUMBER 1: GOD OWNS EVERYTHING

As Paul wrote to Timothy, "For we have brought nothing into the world, so we cannot take anything out of it either" (1 Timothy 6:7). Once you accept the fact that God owns everything, it's important to manage all you have according to His rules. It's how you manage money that determines how you will manage greater things. For instance, unless you surrender to each other your rights over money, you will not surrender other rights. The question is: isn't it worth sacrificing some short-term indulgences to establish long-term peace in a marriage?

Perhaps the situation I have seen that best demonstrates this principle is where a wife either brings financial assets into a marriage or earns her own money through a job. If she truly believes that a husband and wife are to be one and all that she has belongs to God, she will withhold nothing in the marriage relationship. They will merge their assets and operate from a unified base.

However, if ego or fear of the future takes over, she will resist a total merger and maintain a degree of independence. This is the first wedge Satan uses to ultimately split one back into two. It's a self-first attitude, rather than God-first. Obviously, the same principle applies to the husband's assets and income. As the Proverb says, "There is a way which seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death" (Proverbs 14:12).